

Executive Summary:

DarkHotel is a cyberattack group that conducts highly targeted espionage attacks, primarily against C-level executives, government officials, and high-value individuals. Active for over a decade, they employ advanced tactics like zero-day exploits, spear phishing, and hotel Wi-Fi compromises to steal sensitive information.

How DarkHotel Attacks Work

DarkHotel typically uses:

Hotel Wi-Fi Exploits: Infecting hotel networks to deliver malware disguised as legitimate software updates.

Spear Phishing Emails: Personalized emails with malicious attachments targeting political or corporate officials.

Peer-to-Peer Malware: Distributing backdoor Trojans through P2P networks.

Zero-Day Exploits: Exploiting vulnerabilities in widely used software like Adobe and Internet Explorer.

Here we are talking about a particular attack which involves a malicious, it was a MS Excel Spreadsheet file of 109.50 kB which was first seen in 2022-01-13.

Its File hash is:

SHA-1 965c6725acdaf2e82296302dc676cd93365288a9

SHA-256 a251ac8cec78ac4f39fc5536996bed66c3436f8c16d377922187ea61722c71f8

And it was related to Domain: fsm-gov.com

With Subdomain:

hostmaster.fsm-gov.com 160.16.200.77

fsm-gov.com 160.16.200.77

www.fsm-gov.com 160.16.200.77

webmail.fsm-gov.com 23.111.184.119

cpcalendars.fsm-gov.com 23.111.184.119

mail.fsm-gov.com 23.111.184.119

webdisk.fsm-gov.com 23.111.184.119

cpcontacts.fsm-gov.com 23.111.184.119

cpanel.fsm-gov.com 23.111.184.119

The particular NS Records of this domain is:

172.64.53.3

172.64.52.161

And the Possible C2s is: 23.111.184.119

And Connected Ips are:

23.111.184.119

192.168.0.1

Methodology

Tools used For subdomain finding:

Sublist3r

Subfinder

CRT.sh

Tools used For finding NS Records:

DNSDumpster

Whois Lookup

Tools used For information and logs gathering:

Virustotal

OSINT platforms:

WHOIS records

[0x00sec - The Home of the Hacker](#)

Dark web forums:

[http://forums56xf3ix34sooai04x5n275h4i7ktliy4yphhxohuemjppgovrad.onion/](#)

[http://hellhoh5o35sylvxrpfu45p5r74n2lvirnvshmziuvn7bcejlynaqxyd.onion/](#)

Detailed Analysis

Subdomain and IP discoveries, port/service details.

hostmaster.fsm-gov.com 160.16.200.77

fsm-gov.com 160.16.200.77

www.fsm-gov.com 160.16.200.77

webmail.fsm-gov.com 23.111.184.119

cpcalendars.fsm-gov.com 23.111.184.119

mail.fsm-gov.com 23.111.184.119

webdisk.fsm-gov.com 23.111.184.119

cpcontacts.fsm-gov.com 23.111.184.119

cpanel.fsm-gov.com 23.111.184.119

Ip discovered:

23.111.184.119

192.168.0.1

IP Traffic:

UDP 192.168.0.1:53

TCP 23.111.184.119:80 (fsm-gov.com)

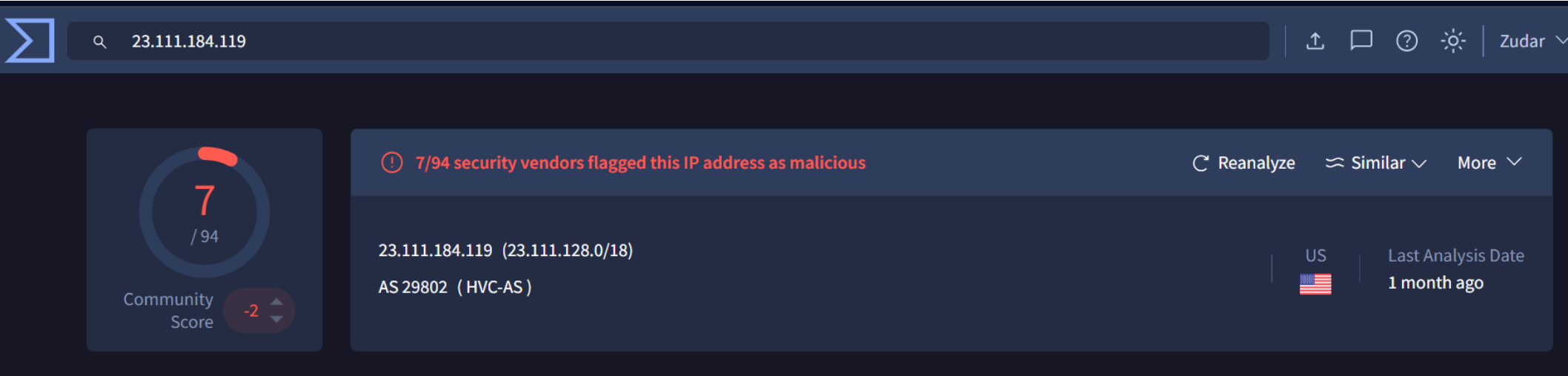
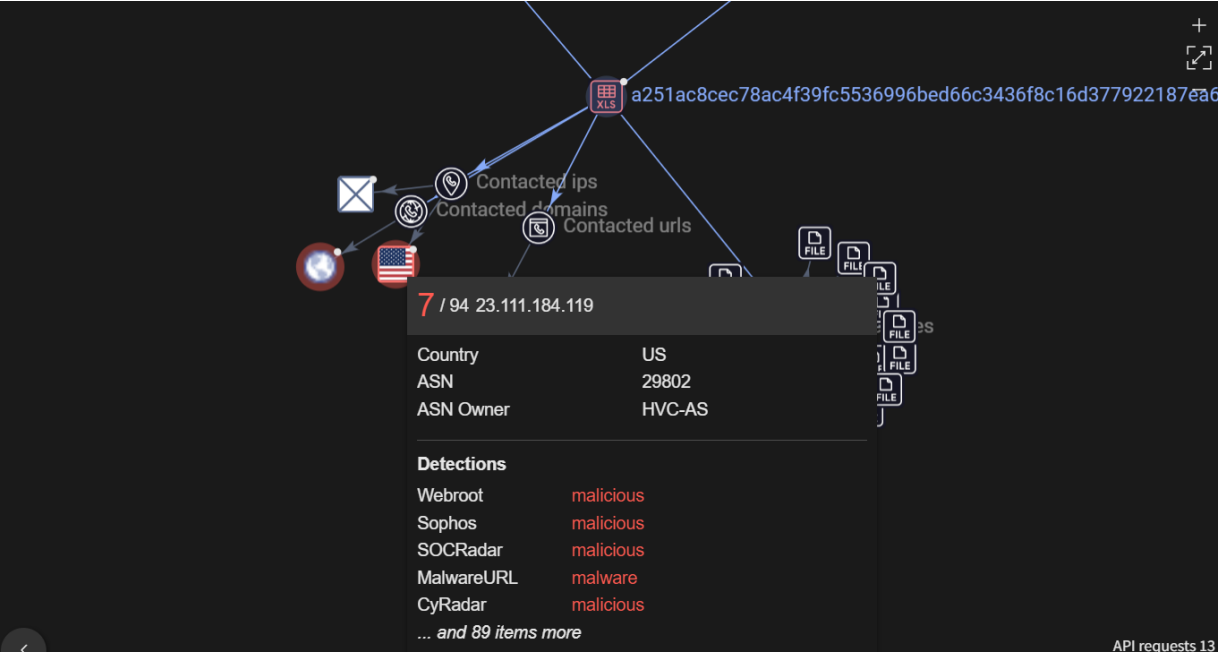
TCP 23.111.184.119:443 (fsm-gov.com)

Discovered forum or onion site references to DarkHotel.

<http://dreadytofatroptsdj6io7l3xptbet6onoyno2yv7jicoxknyazubrad.onion/post/be6ad98adef90e22297a>

<http://dreadytofatroptsdj6io7l3xptbet6onoyno2yv7jicoxknyazubrad.onion/post/183bdea45b2ab381a753>

Evidence of malicious behavior or C2 hosting.



Attribution & TTPs

Execution(TA0002)

Command and Scripting Interpreter(T1059)

PowerShell(T1059.001)

Scripting(T1064)

Native API(T1106)

Exploitation for Client Execution(T1203)

Privilege Escalation(TA0004)

Process Injection(T1055)

Defense Evasion(TA0005)

Obfuscated Files or Information(T1027)

Masquerading(T1036)

Process Injection(T1055)

Scripting(T1064)

Virtualization/Sandbox Evasion(T1497)

Conclusion & Recommendations:

Conclusion

The DarkHotel malware campaign is a highly advanced cyber-espionage operation targeting business executives and government officials. The group uses zero-day vulnerabilities, phishing emails, and compromised Wi-Fi networks to deliver malware, making it a persistent and stealthy threat.

Mitigation Strategies

To defend against DarkHotel attacks, organizations should:

- Block Malicious Domains: Regularly update domain blacklists and use DNS filtering solutions.
- Endpoint Protection: Deploy EDR tools and enforce application whitelisting.
- Monitor IoCs: Use threat intelligence platforms to track known IPs, hashes, and domains.
- Email Security: Implement DMARC, DKIM, and SPF to block spoofing and phishing emails.
- Patch Management: Regularly update software and conduct vulnerability scans.

Recommendation to improve detection and response:

- Monitor Dark Web forums for leaked data and IoCs.
- Deploy Honeypots to detect suspicious activity.
- Share Threat Intelligence with ISAC communities.
- Reverse Engineer Malware using dynamic analysis tools.

By following these steps, organizations can strengthen their cybersecurity defenses and reduce the risk of DarkHotel attacks.

Appendices:

Search for IoCs, Threat Actors, or Malware

40

/ 62

Community Score

-1

40/62 security vendors flagged this file as malicious

Reanalyze

Similar

a251ac8cec78ac4f39fc5536996bed66c3436f8c16d377922187ea61722c71f8

Size

109.50 KB

Last Analysis Date

25 days ago

信息.xls

xls

obfuscated

macros

create-file

write-file

auto-open

long-sleeps

create-ole

calls-wmi

macro-powershell

environ

detect-debug-environment

DETECTION

DETAILS

RELATIONS

BEHAVIOR

COMMUNITY 14

Contacted URLs (1)

Scanned	Detections	Status	URL
2025-02-07	6 / 96	200	http://fsm-gov.com/

Contacted Domains (1)

Domain	Detections	Created	Registrar
fsm-gov.com	7 / 94	2024-12-24	-

Contacted IP addresses (2)



🔍 a251ac8cec78ac4f39fc5536996bed66c3436f8c16d377922187ea61722c71f8

Contacted URLs (1) ⓘ

Scanned	Detections	Status	URL
2025-02-07	6 / 96	200	http://fsm-gov.com/

Contacted Domains (1) ⓘ

Domain	Detections	Created	Registrar
fsm-gov.com	7 / 94	2024-12-24	-

Contacted IP addresses (2) ⓘ

IP	Detections	Autonomous System	Country
192.168.0.1	0 / 94	-	-
23.111.184.119	7 / 94	29802	US



Identity Search

[Group by Issuer](#)**Criteria**

Type: Identity Match: ILIKE Search: 'fsm-gov.com'

Certificates

crt.sh ID	Logged At ↑	Not Before	Not After	Common Name	Matching Identities	Issuer Name
6154197669	2022-02-11	2022-02-11	2022-05-12	fsm-gov.com	cpanel.fsm-gov.com cpcalendars.fsm-gov.com cpcontacts.fsm-gov.com fsm-gov.com mail.fsm-gov.com webdisk.fsm-gov.com webmail.fsm-gov.com www.fsm-gov.com	C=US, ST=TX, L=Houston, O="cPanel, Inc.", CN="cPanel, Inc. Certification Authority"
6154197502	2022-02-11	2022-02-11	2022-05-12	fsm-gov.com	cpanel.fsm-gov.com cpcalendars.fsm-gov.com cpcontacts.fsm-gov.com fsm-gov.com mail.fsm-gov.com webdisk.fsm-gov.com webmail.fsm-gov.com www.fsm-gov.com	C=US, ST=TX, L=Houston, O="cPanel, Inc.", CN="cPanel, Inc. Certification Authority"
5643734220	2021-11-20	2021-11-20	2022-02-18	fsm-gov.com	cpanel.fsm-gov.com cpcalendars.fsm-gov.com cpcontacts.fsm-gov.com fsm-gov.com mail.fsm-gov.com webdisk.fsm-gov.com webmail.fsm-gov.com www.fsm-gov.com	C=US, ST=TX, L=Houston, O="cPanel, Inc.", CN="cPanel, Inc. Certification Authority"
5643734427	2021-11-20	2021-11-20	2022-02-18	fsm-gov.com	cpanel.fsm-gov.com cpcalendars.fsm-gov.com cpcontacts.fsm-gov.com fsm-gov.com mail.fsm-gov.com webdisk.fsm-gov.com webmail.fsm-gov.com www.fsm-gov.com	C=US, ST=TX, L=Houston, O="cPanel, Inc.", CN="cPanel, Inc. Certification Authority"

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IndexError: list index out of range

**[ - ] Total Unique Subdomains Found: 7**

www.fsm-gov.com

cpanel.fsm-gov.com

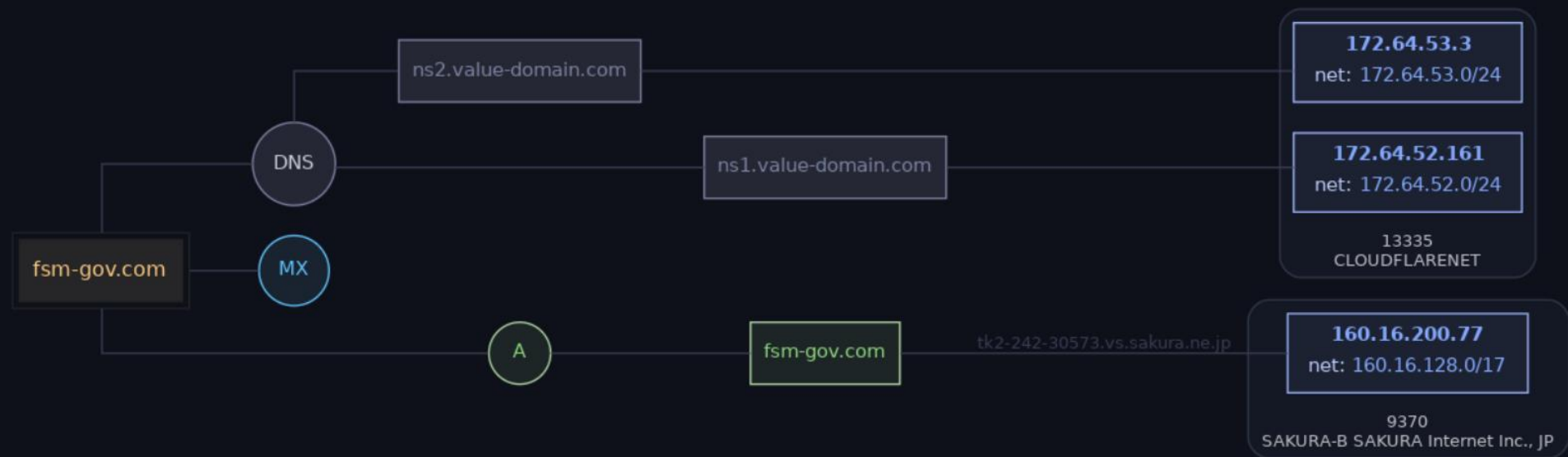
cpcalendars.fsm-gov.com

cpcontacts.fsm-gov.com

mail.fsm-gov.com

webdisk.fsm-gov.com

webmail.fsm-gov.com



map generated by dnsdumpster.com